



HARVESTING

Zucchini and summer squashes should be harvested when they are small, at about 4 in (10 cm) long, when they are at their most flavorful. Regular picking will encourage the plants to produce a greater number of fruits.

Marrow squashes can be harvested when they are about 6 in (15 cm) long. They can be left to grow much larger, and will develop a thick, protective skin.

STORING

Allow marrow squashes to develop a thick skin, and store undamaged crops in a warm, dry place.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Ensuring that plants are well-watered and well-ventilated will help to prevent the most common diseases, such as powdery mildew and cucumber mosaic virus. You may need to support plants carefully to prevent fruits from becoming cramped. Remove and destroy any infected plant material and, if necessary, apply an appropriate insecticide. Seedlings and developing plants are vulnerable to slugs and snails. Use pellets, set up traps, or lay a line of sand or grit, or copper tape, around the base of your plants.